The First Post Round

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 14

At camp, Nib lifted a flag above the new post rack. Lark laid the three replies beneath it. Before they celebrated, each reply needed its destination beside it, and the route book needed the details another courier would actually use. The flag could wait while the record became clear.

“Delivered. Returned. Remembered,” Nib declared with satisfaction. “Ready for someone else to follow,” Lark added warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **puff**

“In stamp, keep the beginning sounds close: /s/, /t/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Don't slip a vowel between them. Join the rest, then read step the same way. All the familiar sounds keep their jobs when consonants stand side by side.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try stamp, tent, flag, step. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the rack labels and our return notes,” Lark invited warmly. “Which destination belongs with each reply?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can stamp. Pat can step.**

“Who can stamp?” Lark asked gently. “Which friend has the other job?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark supplied the place names while you checked the short labels and route pictures. Reed Hut's flap, the Mill bin, and Fern Lodge's sack hook matched the three pockets. Nib set the flag above a rack that now told the whole story. Neighbors arrived to use the library, and a little post horn joined your collection.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write stamp beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Nib gave the horn one cheerful note. Lark bound fourteen journal chapters into Through the Woods. The post circuit was working: three invitations out, three replies home. One reply invited a later visit to Lookout Hill. Tonight, the second book stood finished beside the first.